



GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY · GCC-FIRST · 2026

Spotly

Discover. Plan. Remember.

How we take a finished, two-sided family-outings platform to market — acquiring families, onboarding establishments, and ranking in search — starting in Kuwait and scaling across the GCC.

Two layers of supply — and what each earns

Spotly is useful the moment it opens because the catalogue already exists (~2,700 AI-screened kid-friendly places in Kuwait). But it's important to be exact about what makes money: **discovery is free and universal; a venue only generates sales once we onboard it and add its vouchers/booking.**

LAYER 1 — FREE DISCOVERY (NO ONBOARDING)

- Every AI-screened place appears in Discover, the Map, and the AI planner.
- Families **find, plan, save, visit and remember** — full value, zero merchant action.
- This drives **engagement** → which powers the revenue that needs *no* merchant.

LAYER 2 — COMMERCE (MUST BE ONBOARDED)

- To **sell on Spotly**, a venue must be claimed/onboarded with **vouchers or bookings** added.
- Only these places show "View offers / Book" and generate transaction revenue.
- So **merchant onboarding is the revenue critical path** — even though usage isn't gated on it.

WHICH REVENUE NEEDS MERCHANTS — AND WHICH DOESN'T

REVENUE STREAM	NEEDS ONBOARDING?	WHY IT MATTERS AT LAUNCH
Spotly Plus subscription	No	Monetises every family from day one — independent of any merchant.
Printed albums & prints	No	The marquee earner; needs only family photos, not merchants. De-risked base.
Voucher commerce (take-rate)	Yes	Needs the venue onboarded + vouchers live. Cash-upfront hook for merchants.
Booking commission	Yes	Needs the venue accepting bookings on Spotly.
Promoted placement / merchant SaaS	Yes	Sold to onboarded brands; scales with merchant density.

The two consequences that shape the whole plan

1. Because Plus + albums need no merchants, **we can launch and earn with families alone** — growth is not blocked by the chicken-and-egg.
2. Because transaction revenue needs onboarding, we run a **concentrated merchant push for density** — onboard the venues families already view most so "buy/book" feels alive, rather than scattering thinly.

Lead with demand, concentrate supply, then expand

Most marketplaces stall on cold-start. Spotly's free directory removes the family-side risk, so we lead with families and use real traffic as the lever to onboard venues for the commerce layer.

PHASE	GOAL	PRIMARY MOTION
P0 · Pre-launch (4–8 wks)	Waitlist + 5–10 anchor brands + SEO/ASO foundation	Beta, founding-partner outreach, programmatic SEO build, listings
P1 · Kuwait launch	Prove activation & retention; seed commerce density	Influencers, schools/nurseries, paid social, PR + onboard top-viewed venues
P2 · Monetise & loop	Turn usage into revenue + virality	Albums, Plus, vouchers, referral engine, birthday offers
P3 · GCC expansion	Saudi → UAE → Qatar, each pre-screened	Repeat playbook; AI sweep seeds each new market

Win Kuwait decisively first

A dense, beloved single market — strong retention, live commerce in popular areas, a referral loop that compounds — beats five thin markets. Each new GCC market launches pre-curated by the same AI sweep (~\$20 of Google calls + Claude screening), so expansion is cheap once the playbook works.

LAUNCH-READINESS GATES (CLOSE BEFORE PAID ACQUISITION)

Secure the stack

EC2 proxy → HTTPS; rotate the exposed APNs key + service accounts before listings go public.

Payments live

Stripe wired before marketing vouchers/albums as purchasable (currently mock).

Listings + analytics

Bilingual ASO live; GA4 events defined so launch isn't flown blind.

Acquiring families

GCC parents are mobile-first and high-spend, living on Instagram, TikTok and **Snapchat** (don't skip Snap in the Gulf). Ranked by leverage:

BUILT-IN LOOPS · CHEAPEST

Virality already in the app

Memory sharing (share a finished album/memory card — every share is an ad parents *want* to post), **family invites** (deep links, incentivised), and a **referral program** (free album mini / KWD off both sides).

COMMUNITY · BEST ROI

Where Gulf parents already are

Nurseries, schools, KGs (one director = dozens of families; co-branded weekend guides / class albums), **WhatsApp & IG mom-communities**, **pediatric clinics & kids' salons** (QR in waiting rooms).

CREATORS

Family micro-influencers

10k–100k mom/family creators beat mega-influencers here. Give them a personalised AI plan + a free album of their kids; they post the *output*, not an ad read.

PAID · AFTER PMF SIGNALS

Performance, once retention's proven

Geo-targeted Meta / TikTok / **Snap** to parents 25–45; Apple Search Ads + Google App campaigns. Creative = the memory book & the AI plan, not feature lists. Keep small until LTV:CAC is understood.

Activation is the job, not just installs

An install only counts once a family completes setup and takes a first action (save a place, generate a plan, add a memory). Optimise the first session for one "wow" — the AI plan or the first memory — and prompt a review right after it.

Onboarding establishments (the revenue path)

They're already listed (AI-screened), so this is **land-and-expand, not cold seeding**. The wedge is their own data: *"Families on Spotly are already discovering you — claim your listing free, see who's viewing you, then add offers to convert them."* The merchant analytics you built is the sales tool.

TARGET ORDER — DENSITY > BREADTH

- 1 **Multi-branch family brands** (edutainment, indoor play, trampoline parks, family F&B with play areas). One deal = many branches via the brand→country→branch hierarchy. Highest BD leverage.
- 2 **Malls** — aggregate dozens of family tenants + double as a marketing channel. A mall partnership = bulk supply.
- 3 **The most-viewed places** in the app — use analytics to target the venues families already look at most. Highest-converting onboarding targets; they create commerce density where attention already is.
- 4 **Independents** via the self-serve claim flow — scalable, near-zero sales cost.

THE SHARPEST PITCH

- **Cash upfront:** "Sell prepaid vouchers on Spotly and get paid *before* the family visits." Cash-flow + new customers is an easy SME yes.
- **Their own traffic:** show view/click/booking trends — proof, not promises.
- **Done-for-you onboarding:** claim + add vouchers in the first meeting.

FOUNDING PARTNER PROGRAM

- First ~50 venues: **free promoted placement 3–6 months** + free CRM tier + "Founding Partner" badge.
- Trade free promotion for a **social shout-out** → reverse-acquires families.
- Relationship-led, in-person BD (Gulf B2B isn't won over email).

Why density matters

If only a handful of venues have live vouchers, families rarely hit a "buy" moment and commerce revenue stays flat. Concentrate onboarding so popular areas/categories feel **shoppable** — then transaction revenue compounds with usage.

SEO & ASO — your most defensible channel

You own a curated dataset competitors don't — that's a moat for both the app stores and the web.

ASO

Rank in the app stores (drives installs)

Bilingual EN + AR listings. Keywords: *kids activities Kuwait, things to do with kids, family outings, indoor play, kid-friendly restaurants* + Arabic (أماكن عائلية, أنشطة الأطفال). Outcome-led screenshots. **Reviews are the #1 lever** — prompt after a great moment.

PROGRAMMATIC WEB SEO

Local-intent landing pages at scale

From your data: *"Best kid-friendly places in [Area]", "Indoor activities for kids in Kuwait", "Halal family restaurants in [Area]", "Birthday venues in Kuwait"* — hundreds of long-tail pages, bilingual, each funnelling into the app.

CONTENT / GUIDES

Evergreen parenting intent

Weekend guides, hot-/rainy-day indoor lists (ties to the weather-aware planner), birthday-party planning, "new to Kuwait with kids." Earns links + ranks long-tail.

OFF-PAGE

Local + links

Google Business Profile, structured data on venue pages, backlinks from schools, nurseries, parenting sites, malls & press — sourced via the same partnership outreach.

⚠ Compliance guardrail (build it in from day one)

Google Places terms let you persist only the **place_id + your own verdict** — **not** Google's place content (names, photos, reviews). So programmatic pages must be built from **Spotly's own curation/descriptions** (or live API calls rendered client-side), never republished Google data. This is a feature, not a limit: original, genuinely-helpful curation ranks better and is defensible.

Retention, lifecycle & metrics

RETENTION LOOPS (MOSTLY BUILT)

- **Memory loop:** more outings logged → stickier + more album revenue. Nudge "add a memory" after a visit.
- **Birthday engine (DOB):** the highest-intent moment of a family's year — a push (and later a merchant-funded offer) on the child's birthday. Also a merchant product.
- **Lifecycle push:** "this weekend near you," weather-aware ("too hot Saturday — indoor picks"), re-engagement.
- **Plus prompts** at value moments (storage cap, full map).

METRICS TO INSTRUMENT NOW (GA4)

- **North Star:** weekly active families taking a meaningful action (save / plan / memory / book).
- **Funnel:** install → activate → habit (week-2 return / memory) → monetise → refer.
- **Watch:** activation %, D7/D30 retention, **K-factor** (invites + album shares, aim >0.5), album attach-rate, Plus conversion, merchant claim rate, **LTV:CAC ≥ 3:1**.

Two revenue engines, two dashboards

Track the **merchant-independent** engine (Plus + albums per active family) and the **merchant-dependent** engine (voucher/booking GMV × take-rate, gated on onboarding density) separately. They scale on different inputs — families vs. partner onboarding — and conflating them hides where to push.

EXECUTION

First 90 days — Kuwait

DAYS 0–30 · FOUNDATION

Stack	Close launch-readiness gates (HTTPS, rotate secrets, Stripe, GA4 events).
Search	Finalise bilingual ASO; build programmatic SEO pages + 8–10 cornerstone guides.
Demand	Recruit 50–100 beta families via mom-communities + nurseries; stand up referral + memory-share loops.
Supply	Founder-led outreach: sign 5–10 anchor brands + 1–2 malls ; done-for-you voucher onboarding.
Lifecycle	Ship the birthday push worker so it's live from day one.

DAYS 30–60 · SOFT LAUNCH

Launch	Open to waitlist + beta; turn on memory-share + referral incentives.
Creators	Seed 10–15 family micro-influencers with personalised plans + free albums.
Paid test	Small Snap/IG/TikTok test to learn creative + CAC; begin review-prompting.
Supply	Onboard the most-viewed venues (analytics-led) for commerce density.

DAYS 60–90 · SCALE WHAT WORKS

Double down	Pour budget into the 1–2 channels with best CAC + activation.
PR moment	Launch event at an anchor venue (doubles as family + merchant acquisition).
Monetise	Birthday + weekend lifecycle campaigns; push albums & Plus; expand self-serve merchant claims.
Next market	Run the Saudi AI sweep to pre-seed P3.

The one line

Lead with families (the free directory makes the app useful instantly + Plus/albums earn with zero merchants), use the curated dataset for an SEO/ASO moat, and onboard establishments for density — starting with multi-branch brands & malls — so the commerce layer comes alive where attention already is.